Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Manager
Capital Projects Group, Eglinton Crosstown West Extension
Metrolinx, 5090 Explorer Drive

Re: Senior Project Manager, Third-Party Coordination

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Project Manager, Third-Party Coordination position on the Eglinton Crosstown West Extension. I worked at Metrolinx through 2023 and am now an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, one of the authorities a project like this has to bring along. The part of the role I can speak to is the coordination between a project team and the agencies and divisions it depends on.

At the City I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards, and I work with divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, taking an issue through to a resolution that each side can accept. I advise on by-laws and regulations that bear on the right-of-way, I run assigned projects from scoping to recommendations, and I write the briefing notes that put issues and options in front of senior staff. At Metrolinx I assessed operating and infrastructure changes in OpenTrack before they were taken forward, and I built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. This is a senior role leading a team of specialists, and I have not supervised staff. I have not worked on property acquisition, utility relocation or permit approvals, I have not managed a project budget or administered a construction contract, and I know design-build delivery and the Building Transit Faster Act from reading rather than from practice. I do not hold a PMP or a P.Eng., and I do not have the Ontario Class G licence the posting requires for site travel. I am applying because the coordination and negotiation underneath the role are work I already do from the City's side of the table, and I would like to move into project leadership on transit.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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